For the first eight months of Kiran's posting, she, the DIG (Jaydev Sarangi) and the four superintendents (K. R. Kishore, D. P. Diwedi, P. R. Meena and Tarseem Kumar) would lunch together. During the lunch sessions, they would discuss their morning's observations, highlighting specific problems, and chalk out strategies to resolve such problems. There was much to share, and many distances to close, and these luncheon meetings helped save a lot of time. The signals to all and sundry were very clear, i.e., that headquarters and the staff at Tihar worked as a team. The lower staff's options to exploit the situation were thus successfully checked. What emerged out of this approach was that, for the first time, headquarters was not passing down insensitive and incomprehensible orders that were not practical and had, therefore, to be shown as carried out on paper only.

Many earlier IGs held a dual charge and dealing with prisons was too infra dig for them to bother about. They would therefore suggest to the superintendents that they should presume that the IGs were not there. They told them to carry on exactly as they would if they were somewhere else. This meant that there was no responsibility and no accountability attached to the post, but only authority. The prison had never had the benefit of an indulgent and participative leadership. These lunch sessions truly proved beneficial in several ways. For the first time, the lobby consisting of the old warders and assistant warders was made ineffective. They were now being told what to do, and how to do it, and they now knew that there was an effective leadership in the prison.

The headquarters' team and the superintendents would now assess not only the performance but also the behaviour of the lower staff through petitions, actual observation and apparent situations. They were each given ample opportunities to prove their worth. Those found not to have changed their earlier ways were shifted outside the jails so that they had no direct contact with the prisoners and were given security work at the outer perimeter or no work at all. It was better without them! Nothing, however, was presumed. If they did prove their merit, well and good. If they did not, then they were made persona non grata inside the prison. This lowered their prestige in the eyes of the others, and their treatment became exemplary. Their duties were also shuffled around a lot so that their earlier monopolies were effectively broken. But this was possible only because of constant and vigilant observation and coordination. All such endeavour took its toll in the form of extra duties and much longer working hours, but the net result was reward enough.

Gradually, even the warders began to be called to attend briefing sessions. And they showed themselves to be responsive and started to prove themselves to be responsible as well. If they had conducted yoga classes, or prayer meetings, or had organized games in their respective jails, then their names would be put up on the notice boards of the headquarters and their respective jails. Seeing their names displayed on the notice boards made the warders a little competitive amongst themselves and when they had achieved the satisfaction of having done a good job, the entire prison benefited.

Even during the new regime, when a number of reforms were apparently taking place and the mindset of the prison staff was being persuasively changed, the hangover of the past still continued. In a letter to her parents in England, a British girl inmate reported how she had asked a woman warder for some help regarding her visitor rights. She was told that one got nothing for nothing and also that only if she granted sexual favours would her request be attended to. The girl's parents wrote to the IGP and, after enquiring into the matter, the offending warder, a woman home guard, was immediately discharged. This, explained Kiran to her staff during the annual review, was what happened when those who were neither trained nor had any inclination towards the requirements of this service were given such responsibilities. It would be far more in keeping with the present jail culture if the prison